

Tenant leads that already want a broker

How the referral program works, what a lead looks like, what it pays, and what you sign — for licensed salespersons, associate brokers and brokerages.

What's inside	The lead flow · the fee math with worked numbers · a compliance checklist · what the agreement says
Who it's for	Licensed agents and brokerages who answer fast and work a defined patch
Cost to join	Nothing. A broker-to-broker referral fee only after a lease is signed

A renter who has already decided to hire a broker

Most rental “leads” are a name and a phone number attached to an apartment enquiry, sold to four agents at once. A RentLeads lead is different: a renter filled in a brief asking to *hire* a broker, and set the most they’re willing to pay one. You see the area, the budget, the dates and that fee cap before you spend a minute on it.

1 Join & get verified Apply with your licence and sign the referral agreement in the app. We check the licence with the state and countersign.	2 Accept a lead Leads in your markets arrive by email and in your portal. Accept with your fee and a short pitch, or pass in one click.
3 Get chosen & sign The renter compares up to three brokers and picks. The tenant agreement — with your fee — is signed in the app before you start.	4 Close & report Work the search, report the signed lease in your portal, and we invoice your brokerage the referral fee.

What a lead looks like

Field	Example
Where	Brooklyn, NY — Williamsburg, Greenpoint
Home	Apartment · 1 bedroom · new development
Budget	\$3,000–\$3,600 a month
When	Move in within a month · long term
Fee cap	Up to one month's rent (about \$3,600)
Why you	Covers Williamsburg · new-development specialist · replies in under an hour
Not included until you're chosen	The renter's name, email and phone

You have a set window to answer — 24 hours by default. Accept with a fee at or under the cap and two lines on why you’re the right agent; that pitch is the first thing the renter reads. Pass, and the lead moves to the next broker straight away.

What it pays, with real numbers

There is no sign-up fee, no monthly fee and no charge per lead. When a referred renter signs a lease and your brokerage collects its fee, the brokerage pays RentLeaks a referral fee of **25%** of that gross fee — the middle of the 20–35% band that is standard for broker-to-broker referrals. You keep the rest.

Monthly rent	Your fee	Gross to your brokerage	Referral at 25%	Your brokerage keeps
\$2,800	1 month	\$2,800	\$700	\$2,100
\$3,600	0.75 months	\$2,700	\$675	\$2,025
\$3,600	1 month	\$3,600	\$900	\$2,700
\$4,500	12% of the year	\$6,480	\$1,620	\$4,860
\$6,000	1 month	\$6,000	\$1,500	\$4,500

A year, roughly

Accept two leads a week, get chosen on a third of them, close half of those, at an average \$2,700 fee: about 17 leases, roughly \$46,000 gross, about \$34,500 to your brokerage after the 25% referral. Your own numbers will differ — the point is that the cost only ever appears after money arrives.

How leads are shared out

Matching is mechanical, not political. A lead goes to active partners licensed in that state whose markets cover the area, ranked on: how well the markets and specialties fit, median reply time, acceptance rate, leases closed, renter ratings and how recently you were last offered one — with open capacity respected, so nobody gets buried. There is no way to pay for position.

What you sign

Section	What it says
Referrals	Briefs without contact details; accept within the window at or under the cap, or pass.
Referral fee	25% of the gross fee your brokerage receives, for a lease that renter signs within 12 months.
Paid broker to broker	Invoiced to the brokerage after you report the lease, due within 10 days of your brokerage being paid. Never to an individual salesperson.
Licences	Kept active and verifiable; tell us within five business days of any change.
Serving the renter	Signed tenant agreement before any fee; no fee for homes your brokerage lists for the landlord; every disclosure and fair-housing rule followed.

Section	What it says
Records	Agreements and fee records kept at least three years.
Ending it	30 days' email notice either way. Fees for renters introduced earlier stay payable.

New York Real Property Law § 442 is the reason the money moves brokerage to brokerage: a salesperson or associate broker can't take or pay a referral fee directly, so your supervising broker signs alongside you and the invoice goes to the firm.

Compliance checklist

Print this, tick it once, keep it with your files. It is the short version of what the agreement asks of you — and what regulators look for after the fact.

☐	My licence is active, and the name on it matches the name on my RentLeaks profile.
☐	My supervising broker knows about the program and has signed the referral agreement.
☐	I have the signed tenant representation & fee agreement before charging a renter anything.
☐	I never charge a referred renter for a home my brokerage lists for the landlord (FARE Act).
☐	I never make a specific home conditional on being hired.
☐	Every ad, conversation and screening standard follows fair-housing law — the home, never the people.
☐	Agency and fee disclosures are given when the law requires them, in writing (in NY, DOS-1735-f).
☐	I don't ask a renter for money before a viewing and a lease to sign.
☐	I update the client's stage in the portal at least every two weeks.
☐	I report a signed lease within five business days, with the fee my brokerage actually collected.
☐	Agreements and fee records are kept for at least three years.

Getting more out of it

- **Answer fast.** Reply time is the single biggest input into who gets the next lead — and renters pick the first good pitch they read.
- **Write the pitch for one renter.** Name the buildings you know, the day you can show, the thing you'd warn them about. Two specific lines beat a paragraph of adjectives.
- **Price for the search, not the rent.** A 0.75-month fee that gets chosen beats a one-month fee that doesn't.
- **Keep your markets honest.** List the neighbourhoods you actually work; mismatched leads cost you both time and standing.
- **Add your headshot.** Verified partners with a photo and a line of bio are the ones renters recognise on the page — and the ones we feature.

Apply in two minutes

rentleaks.com/hire-a-broker/agents.html — licence, markets, specialties. You'll sign the referral agreement in the app; we verify the licence with the state and countersign, then your portal opens and leads start arriving.

This kit describes the RentLeaks referral partner program and is general information, not legal advice. Licensing and fee rules vary by state; the signed agreement governs. The referral percentage is the current default and is fixed for you by your signed agreement.